Internationally, UAV programs expanded in parallel. Israel Aerospace Industries (IAI) continued to lead innovation with systems such as the Heron (1994) and Heron TP (Eitan) (2004), which introduced longer endurance, multi-sensor payloads, and satellite data links. These drones played crucial roles in intelligence operations, maritime patrol, and border surveillance. Meanwhile, in Europe, the Dassault Neuron and BAE Systems Taranis projects demonstrated growing interest in stealth and autonomous combat UAVs (UCAVs), integrating radar-absorbing materials and autonomous targeting systems.

The US military and its allies increasingly integrated UAVs into network-centric warfare, linking real-time drone data with ground and air command units. This allowed drones to perform persistent surveillance, target identification, and precision engagement in synchronized operations. The MQ-9 Reaper (2007) further extended UAV capability, featuring higher speed, heavier payload capacity, and enhanced weapon systems, solidifying the drone's role as a multi-mission combat platform.

By the 2010s, third-generation drones had transitioned from experimental programs to core assets in global defense and intelligence operations. Their reliability, range, and precision enabled 24/7 surveillance, cross-border reconnaissance, and unmanned strike missions with minimal human risk. Beyond military applications, the same technological breakthroughs spurred the emergence of commercial UAVs equipped with GPS, inertial navigation, and high-definition cameras, leading to widespread civilian adoption for mapping, infrastructure inspection, and disaster management.

Table 4.1 presents a chronological overview of the major UAV systems that define the third generation of drones, highlighting their development timeline, technological advancements, and strategic impact. This generation, spanning from the mid-1990s to 2015, marked the integration of